



MONTHLY UPDATE

Ghana: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 • 76 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA

Summary of the month

Two government portals broke in the same fortnight. Tax payment processing on the services portal [failed from 14 August and was still unresolved a week later](#), and the [online passport application portal went down, the outage confirmed by the foreign ministry](#). Against that, government [directed that public-service salaries be suspended from 15 September for staff whose identity-card details do not match](#) – a state making its own systems a condition of pay while two of its public-facing systems are down.

Enforcement is the month's other thread, and it is unusually visible. The information-rights commission [fined 254 public bodies over reporting delays](#); the cybersecurity authority's first published fines against a public body and its supplier [were called premature and referred to the Attorney-General](#); and the data protection commission [took delivery of field-enforcement vehicles](#). On virtual assets a [coordinating committee was inaugurated](#), and a bank [opened direct renminbi settlement](#). The minister also [announced a cut in fibre broadband prices, effective the same day](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The government [announced a ten-year artificial-intelligence implementation plan on 29 July](#) with measurable annual milestones, built with United Nations partners.

The wider reform the digital pillar sits in reached validation on 12 August: a [five-year, seven-pillar public sector reform strategy was validated at a stakeholder workshop ahead of formal adoption](#), one pillar being digitalised [public-sector systems](#). No text, budget or adoption date is published.

Legislation and regulation

The ministry took industry comment on 27 July on the [draft digital economy and innovation development fund bill](#); the levy rate and governance structure are unestablished, and the draft is not published. Speaking at an artificial-intelligence summit on 29 July, the ministry named a data harmonisation Act and a proposed data exchange Act as the enabling layer under a ten-year implementation plan — the first mention on file of an exchange statute distinct from harmonisation, and neither has a published draft.

Data protection

The data-protection regulator's own enforcement record did not change; the action framed as a data-privacy violation in the month was taken by the central bank. But the cyber security authority produced the first enforcement of its kind the base holds, and its subject is another arm of the state. It [fined the Registrar of Companies GH¢240,000 for engaging an unlicensed cybersecurity provider and fined that provider GH¢120,000 for operating without a licence](#), after the registrar ignored a June 2026 directive to engage a licensed tier-one critical-information-infrastructure provider under the Cybersecurity Act 2020. The registrar has since contested it, [saying the procurement of its network and security operations centre was substantially complete before the tier-one directive was issued](#); no adjudication of that timeline is held.

Regional collaboration

Ghana's regional position moved on three fronts, none of them with a text attached. African Union ministers [endorsed continental roll-out of the illicit-financial-flows policy tracker](#) from the six-country pilot Ghana ran over eighteen months, the finance ministry reporting that it contributed to recovering millions of dollars in revenue — with no Ghana-specific score, finding or reform list published. The communications ministry [announced a partnership on digital-policy intelligence and regulatory-analysis tools](#) at an Accra workshop on 10 August, covering the national AI strategy, data-governance work and the coders programme, with no funding, duration or deliverables stated. And the [fintech licence passporting memorandum with Rwanda remains unpublished by either central bank](#) eighteen months after signature, so which licence categories are recognised, and on what conditions, is still unestablished.

A fourth front does have something running. A continental alliance and a German development agency say [a digital identity issued in Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining](#). No scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The statistical service put a number on what digitisation is being asked to fix. Its governance series records citizens reporting demands for unofficial payments [rising from 51% in the first half of 2025 to 69% in the second](#), and the service names digitalisation, fee transparency and public education as its response, citing a marked fall in bribery at the passport office after digitisation and saying the Office of the Chief of Staff has directed the ten institutions the series flagged as high-risk to report back on remediation. The passport-office comparison is asserted without a before-and-after figure, and the series measures reported demands rather than cases proven.

The same week the ministry took the governance argument outward and inward at once: it [convened an Accra workshop with a policy-monitoring organisation and a trade endowment on digital governance, regulatory coordination and international digital-trade engagement](#), framed against the national artificial-intelligence strategy, the coders programme and the continental digital trade protocol; and its deputy minister [urged information-management professionals to secure and better manage government data as artificial-intelligence use grows](#). Neither produces an instrument, and the national data strategy has been In development since 2024.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

The country renewed the agreement under which several of its digital customs systems are financed. The [TradeMark Africa country programme memorandum was renewed on 14 August](#), continuing trade-facilitation and continental-free-trade-readiness work, including digital customs systems at the Akanu-Noepe joint border post and support for

more than 1,250 women and small-scale cross-border traders. No financing sum, term or workplan is stated — and the same border post is where a regional dialogue on identity-card and transit-system interoperability was held four days earlier.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator's [consolidated response of 31 July](#) answered sixty written queries from four prospective applicants, formally amended the request for applications in seven places, and shifted every subsequent date by 21 days, with licence fees now due 17 November. [It refused any extension to the 70% population coverage obligation of 6 March 2027 while confirming that obligation is band- and technology-neutral and can be met in substantial part from existing deployment.](#) It also rewrote the dominant operator's rural schedule from licence-relative years into fixed dates of December 2029, 2032 and 2035, expressly so that buying spectrum would not accelerate an equivalent existing commitment. [And it recharacterised the 40% premium on that operator's reserve prices in writing as a price for attributable value rather than a sanction or a market-power remedy, declining to publish its valuation model during a live assignment.](#)

Beneath the licensing argument, the traffic that never leaves the country was counted. On 16 August the Accra exchange was reported [past 200 Gbps, against three exchanges that barely overlap: only 4 of 39 connected networks peer at all three, so most local traffic still transits abroad.](#) The headline figure is the smaller finding. An exchange is worth the traffic it keeps local, and three partly-overlapping exchanges keep less of it than one would.

Technical Capacity

The cable inventory did not move; what moved is the base's reading of it. The regulator [names five submarine cable providers on an undated page](#) resting the licence on section 3(8) of the Electronic Communications Act 2008, a list that predates later landings, while an analyst brief [counts six cables at Accra and about 2.5 Tbps of international capacity in use](#) on a 2024 estimate. Neither is the regulator's own current count.

Cybersecurity

A community-media cyber capability project launched on 3 August, certifying community-radio journalists into a standing press corps.

The Cybersecurity Act's licensing regime produced its first published penalties. The Cyber Security Authority [fined the Office of the Registrar of Companies and Purpleline Solutions a combined GH¢360,000 for breaching the Act's licensing requirements](#) on 13 August — [GH¢240,000 against the Registrar in two penalties of GH¢120,000 for engaging an unlicensed cybersecurity service provider, and GH¢120,000 against the provider for operating without a licence.](#) One of the two penalised bodies is itself a state registry. Five days later the Authority [fined a Big Four firm's Ghana practice GH¢360,000 — three penalties of GH¢120,000 — for continuing to provide regulated cybersecurity services, including to owners of critical information infrastructure, after three directives to obtain a licence, ordering it to cease and desist, governance, risk and compliance work included.](#) The base holds no published penalty under the Act before 13 August, so both actions fall inside six days, and the Authority states it will name unlicensed providers publicly as an enforcement measure. Neither of the two largest penalties survived the week as announced. The firm's fine was declared [satisfactorily resolved in a joint statement issued the same day](#), which does not state whether it was paid, reduced or withdrawn; and the Registrar [rejected its own sanction as premature and procedurally unfair, dating a finance-ministry commitment authorisation to 28 November 2025 and its tender to 4 December, before the directive it is said to have breached.](#) A regime whose first week of enforcement produces one settlement without terms and one contested timeline has published a gross figure, not a collected one.

The regulator also [held a two-day consultative and validation workshop with UNICEF Ghana on online child sexual exploitation and abuse](#), reviewing the national response and naming coordination and frontline-capacity gaps; no instrument or programme follows from it on the record.

It started teaching. A session at Accra on 19 August [put newsroom devices to journalists as deliberate targets rather than accidental victims, citing an Angolan journalist's 2024 spyware infection as the regional precedent](#). No count of journalists trained under the project has been published.

DPI

Data Exchange

Interoperable mobile-money transfers ran to [33.5 million transactions worth GH¢6.2bn in June](#) — about 1.3% of total mobile-money value. The share, not the volume, is the measure of interoperability, and it is the figure that has stayed small since the service went live in 2018.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity regulator publicised amendment regulations on 16 July that had come into force on 9 June, and the interior minister then set the enforcement date: banks, telecoms operators, hospitals, schools, insurers and agencies have [a three-month transition from 27 July to 2 November 2026](#) to install readers and integrate with the verification service, on a sanctions ladder running to suspension of access and licence withdrawal. Verification tied to SIM registration is explicitly excluded, with no timetable announced.

The first paid round-the-clock identity centre opened on 1 August with all services attracting approved charges and no fee schedule published; by 13 August the agency described the Labone centre as [running registration on three shifts around the clock](#), presented as part of the government's wider 24-hour economy programme. No throughput or staffing figure is published, and the base holds no equivalent extension of the free daytime service.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Central bank data for June 2026 put mobile money at [954 million transactions worth GH¢492.9bn](#), against GH¢323.2bn a year earlier, on 84.6 million registered wallets of which 26.4 million were active; [interoperable transfers were GH¢6.2bn, about 1.3% of value](#).

Enforcement of the digital-credit regime opened. A notice of 20 July recorded the 30 June licensing deadline as elapsed, and a notice of [3 August named twenty unlicensed lending applications](#), cautioning banks and payment providers against processing for them and framing the harm first as a violation of customer data privacy. The promised register of licensed providers remains unpublished.

The dominant operator opened a channel to the next cohort of providers instead. A [three-month fintech accelerator launched on 12 August across Accra, Kumasi and Tamale](#), with a domestic technology firm as its official technology partner. No cohort size, selection criteria, funding or equity terms are stated.

Card acceptance widened from outside the domestic rails. A commercial bank and an international card scheme [opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Ghana on 19 August](#), settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Ghana.

Sectoral management information systems

One sectoral system was assessed rather than built. A Danish-funded gap assessment of the meteorological agency [reported gaps across its ICT infrastructure, digital systems, data governance and cybersecurity framework](#), presented to the communications ministry in Accra under a bilateral weather and climate cooperation. Neither the assessment text nor any cost, timetable or funding line for the roadmap it recommends is published, so what the month holds is a diagnosis and no commitment to act on it.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The finance ministry reported to Parliament that the customs valuation system had [analysed about 366,000 declarations to 17 July](#), 24% triggering more than one risk indicator, with collections up 17.5% against a 6.3% rise in declared value. A second public sector reform strategy was validated on 30 July on seven pillars, 27 programmes and 135 activities.

The revenue side gained a plan on 12 August. A [Korean-backed Tax Modernisation Master Plan covering income tax, value-added tax, tax administration and electronic tax administration was set out](#), with artificial intelligence already in service on customs valuation. No cost, timetable or implementation schedule accompanies it, which puts it a stage behind the customs system it is presented alongside.

Two systems moved in opposite directions in the same week. The online passport application service [went down on 25 August, the foreign ministry confirming a technical fault the same day and naming no cause and no restoration date](#). The accountant-general's department, meanwhile, [will suspend from 15 September the salaries of government employees whose national identity details are missing from or do not match the payroll system, ahead of a nationwide re-verification exercise](#), the directive prompted by discrepancies surfaced when the upgraded payslip system left some employees unable to open their payslips.

Technology

AI

UNESCO's Accra head replied from the same platform that strategies without funding and execution remain shell documents.

Applications opened on 1 July for an applied artificial-intelligence lab in Accra, closing 31 August with no cohort size or Ghana-specific spend disclosed.

ICT Industry

On 27 July a company filed a writ claiming authorship of the 2007 design of the dominant mobile-money platform; the operator answered on 31 July that the claims are without merit and it will contest fully.

Innovation ecosystem

Two assistive devices are [in pilot with a disability association — smart glasses and an ultrasonic obstacle detector — at a target price of about GH¢2,000 and a 1,500-user target within a year](#).

A freight platform founded in 2023 was profiled on 19 August: it [takes booking, cost estimation, secured payment and cargo tracking, and handles customs formalities and border documentation for importers, exporters and online merchants](#). No volume, revenue or customer figure is stated, and the account is a profile rather than a filing.

Capacity

Literacy

The education council completed a revised basic-education curriculum adding coding, artificial intelligence and technical subjects, announced on 20 July and not yet adopted.

Training and skills

Training capacity was the month's activity. A youth agency [signed for 2,000 vendor-certified microdegree places on 14 July](#) — Ghana taking 2,000 of the 3,000 allocated to the whole continent — fully government-funded, with 600 paid internships and a five-region pilot, and no programme cost disclosed. [A university became the first tertiary institution to embed the national coders programme permanently in its curriculum on 29 July, receiving a further 2,000 laptops the next day.](#)

Inclusion

Access to services

The mid-year fiscal review of 23 July recorded GH¢485m paid to cash-grant beneficiaries in the first half of 2026 and named no allocation at all to the communications ministry, the access fund, the coders programme or the artificial-intelligence strategy.

Digital divides

At a policy dialogue on 29 July the regulator said an existing hotspot authorisation [could found a dedicated community-network regime](#), with no timetable, consultation or draft announced; a civil-society policy lead placed four other African states ahead of Ghana on enabling frameworks.

The [draft digital economy and innovation development fund bill](#) would also convert the universal-access fund into a wider innovation and skills fund, with the fate of the rural-access earmark unestablished.

Existing money went the other way. An implementing partner's account of 12 August reports that [connectivity and digital-inclusion work in Ghana slowed or stopped after the American aid wind-down of 2025, in which 83% of the agency's programmes were cut](#), the multi-funder Women in the Digital Economy Fund losing its American component while the parts other funders backed continued. No replacement funder is named and no Ghanaian figure is given.

Data

National statistics

The statistical service [published the third wave of its six-monthly governance panel on 6 August](#), run across all sixteen regions, with the Government Statistician putting its findings to digital remedies — digitising public services and publishing official fees among them. The report text is not held. Separately the finance minister [asked the service to develop a methodology for quarterly employment statistics](#); none is published and no timetable is set.

Open data

The one open-data movement in the window is a system that exists and a commitment that cannot pay for it. The fisheries ministry and the national multi-stakeholder group built an online Fisheries Information System, launched at an ocean conference in June 2026, but [inadequate funding is constraining the 2024 Fisheries Transparency Initiative](#)

[commitment it sits under](#), with the minister pointing to part of a goods-and-services allocation and to unconcluded talks with Norway on reviving a development funding mechanism. A published system with no secured budget behind the disclosure regime is the familiar shape here, and the national open-data instrument remains **Not held**.

Use of satellite data

Two satellite-derived systems were [named as live deployments at a university lecture reported on 10 August](#): an agricultural information and monitoring system, and a national forest monitoring system paired with a deforestation tracker built toward European deforestation-regulation compliance for cocoa and gold supply chains. Both are named by their builder, and no coverage, accuracy, user or funding figure is published for either.

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